

EXPERIMENT 26

Concealed File Examination

AIM

To identify hidden or potentially concealed files in a directory using filenames and operating-system attributes where available.

ALGORITHM

1. Ask the investigator for a directory.
2. Read every file in the directory.
3. Check for hidden-style names beginning with a dot.
4. On Windows, check the hidden attribute when possible.
5. Display visible and suspicious/hidden files separately.
6. Record the discovery time.

CODE

```
import os
from datetime import datetime

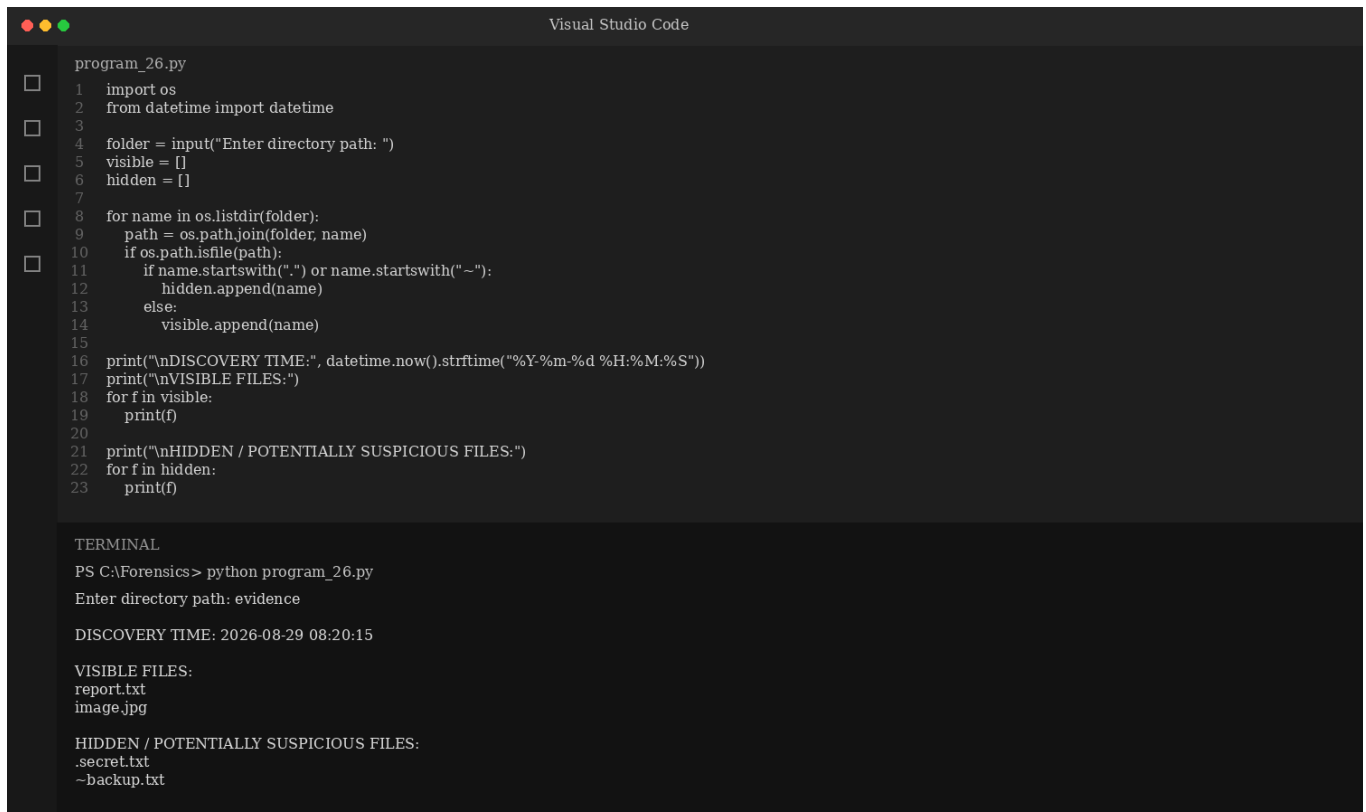
folder = input("Enter directory path: ")
visible = []
hidden = []

for name in os.listdir(folder):
    path = os.path.join(folder, name)
    if os.path.isfile(path):
        if name.startswith(".") or name.startswith("~"):
            hidden.append(name)
        else:
            visible.append(name)

print("\nDISCOVERY TIME:", datetime.now().strftime("%Y-%m-%d %H:%M:%S"))
print("\nVISIBLE FILES:")
for f in visible:
    print(f)

print("\nHIDDEN / POTENTIALLY SUSPICIOUS FILES:")
for f in hidden:
    print(f)
```

OUTPUT



The screenshot displays the Visual Studio Code interface. The editor window shows a Python script named `program_26.py` with 23 lines of code. The code imports `os` and `datetime`, prompts the user for a directory path, and then iterates through the directory's contents. It categorizes files into `visible` (those not starting with a dot or tilde) and `hidden` (those starting with a dot or tilde). The script prints the discovery time, visible files, and hidden files separately. Below the editor, the TERMINAL pane shows the command `PS C:\Forensics> python program_26.py` being executed. The user input `evidence` is shown. The output displays the discovery time as `DISCOVERY TIME: 2026-08-29 08:20:15`, followed by `VISIBLE FILES:` listing `report.txt` and `image.jpg`, and `HIDDEN / POTENTIALLY SUSPICIOUS FILES:` listing `.secret.txt` and `~backup.txt`.

```
program_26.py
1  import os
2  from datetime import datetime
3
4  folder = input("Enter directory path: ")
5  visible = []
6  hidden = []
7
8  for name in os.listdir(folder):
9      path = os.path.join(folder, name)
10     if os.path.isfile(path):
11         if name.startswith(".") or name.startswith("~"):
12             hidden.append(name)
13         else:
14             visible.append(name)
15
16     print("\nDISCOVERY TIME:", datetime.now().strftime("%Y-%m-%d %H:%M:%S"))
17     print("\nVISIBLE FILES:")
18     for f in visible:
19         print(f)
20
21     print("\nHIDDEN / POTENTIALLY SUSPICIOUS FILES:")
22     for f in hidden:
23         print(f)
```

TERMINAL

```
PS C:\Forensics> python program_26.py
Enter directory path: evidence

DISCOVERY TIME: 2026-08-29 08:20:15

VISIBLE FILES:
report.txt
image.jpg

HIDDEN / POTENTIALLY SUSPICIOUS FILES:
.secret.txt
~backup.txt
```

RESULT

The program identifies visible and potentially hidden files in the selected directory.